SDR Onboarding Agent

An AI coworker for the 12-week SDR journey — with a human at every gate

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The big idea

ONBOARDING AN SDR TODAY

A new Sales Development Rep takes **12 weeks** to ramp — and today that ramp is slow, inconsistent, and barely measured.

42%

hit quota

new SDRs (RepVue, Feb 2026)

24–72h

coaching feedback lag

on cold-call reviews

3–5h

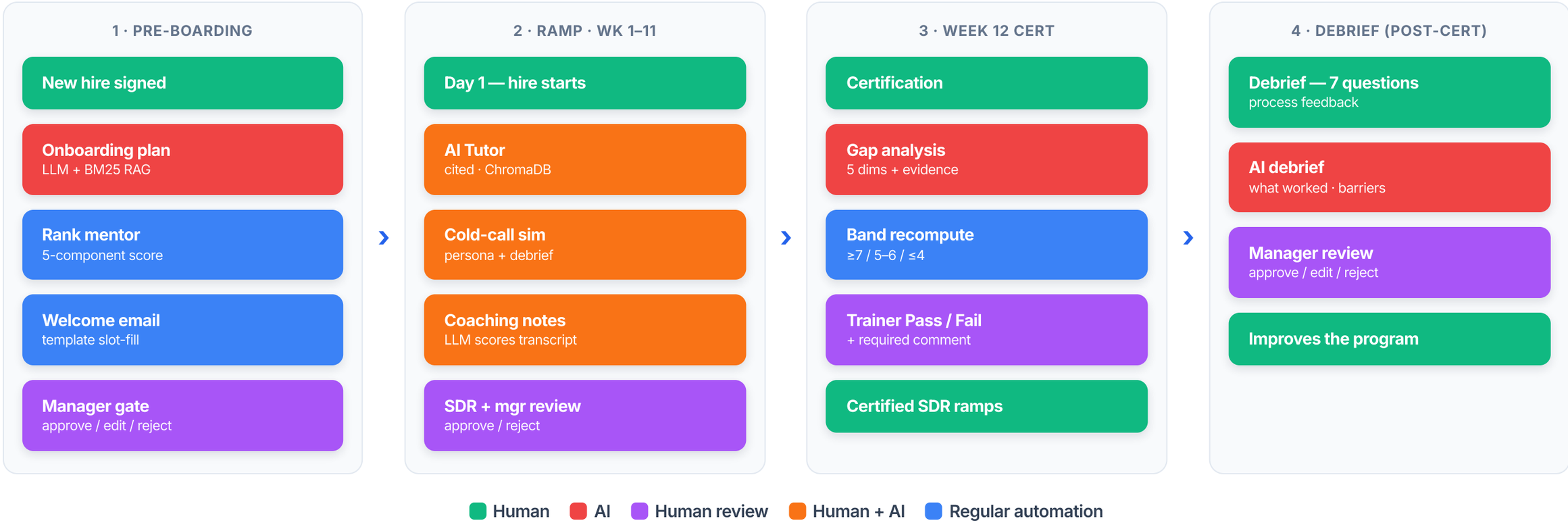
manual call review

per manager, per week

The redesign — one AI coworker for the whole journey: draft the plan → coach the calls → certify at week 12 → debrief to improve the program. A **Manager** reviews every consequential step.

The redesigned workflow

Four phases — pre-boarding, ramp, certification, post-cert debrief — with a Manager review gate in each.



Live demo — two SDRs, two paths

WATCH IT RUN

Priya — the clean path

- Entry SDR · EMEA · healthcare
- AI drafts a personalized 4-week plan + cited sources
- High confidence → **Manager approves** at the gate

Marcus — the review path

- Mid SDR · AMER-West · SaaS
- AI flags **low confidence** (missing profile data)
- Run pauses → **Manager reviews** before anything ships

Real input → useful output, with the **evidence visible** and a **Manager decision** at each step.

Under the hood

Every request — a hire, a question, a transcript — flows through the same pipeline.



7 LLM skills **2** automations **2** retrievers **2** MCP servers **9** UI screens **153** tests passing

One uniform envelope between every step makes the workflow **auditable, idempotent, and safe to gate**.

Data, evidence & AI usage

WHAT THE AI USES — AND WHAT THE USER CAN INSPECT

Data it uses

SDR & AE profiles · per-hire summaries · simulation personas · a 7-SDR records set · call transcripts pasted by the user.

Documents (RAG)

A **16-doc** internal knowledge base — onboarding policy, quota ramp, objection handbook, cold-call rubric, territory + vertical playbooks, certification rubric & exam — plus 7 public references.

Tools / functions

7 LLM skills · **2** deterministic automations · **2** retrievers (BM25 + ChromaDB) · **2** MCP servers.

Evidence the user sees

An **EvidencePanel** with numbered cited sources + match scores · inline `[n]` citations that open the exact passage · per-dimension cards quoting the SDR's own work verbatim.

When evidence is weak or missing: the tutor cites a source or refuses (no bluffing) · confidence < 0.60 blocks auto-complete and pauses for review · a server-side recompute overrides the AI's certification verdict if they disagree.

Human stays in control — five gates

1. **Pre-boarding plan** — Manager approves / edits / rejects / escalates
2. **AI Tutor answer** — SDR approves / rejects; rejection re-enters retrieval
3. **Coaching note** — Manager reviews before the SDR sees it
4. **Certification** — Manager decides Pass/Fail with a required comment
5. **Onboarding debrief** — Manager reviews, then shares with enablement

Two hard safeguards

Confidence < 0.60 **blocks auto-complete** and pauses for review · a server-side recompute **overrides** the AI's certification verdict if they disagree.

Every decision logged

Approve / edit / reject / escalate is written to `decision_log.json` with feature, action and timestamp — a full audit trail.

The business case

TIME, COST & QUALITY · $70/HR FULLY-LOADED (ASSUMPTION)

Pre-boarding step	Today	With AI
Build plan	90–150 min	10–20 min
Match mentor	20–40 min	5–10 min
Welcome email	15–30 min	3–8 min
Total per hire	**125–220 min**	**18–38 min**
Cost per hire	**$146–257**	**$21–44**

$120–215

saved per hire
pre-boarding alone

Coaching review

3–5 hr/wk → **under 1 hr/wk** of manual call review.

Certification

45–75 → **10–15 min** per SDR ($40–71 saved each).

Quality gains

Consistent rubric coaching · cited answers · faster feedback · every decision logged.

Testing — the kinds of checks I ran

I didn't just ship the AI Tutor — an automated **DeepEval** suite judges its answers, rerun to trust the trend over noise.

10 cases × 4 checks

Faithfulness — stays within retrieved sources? · **Answer relevancy** — answers what was asked? · **Citation + next-step** — cites `[n]` and a concrete action? · **SDR face-validity** — useful to a real SDR? Cases span everyday, edge (vague / no-source), and predicted-failure inputs.

What it caught — and the fix

It flagged real failures: over-answering vague questions, a fabricated module-ID, generic next-steps. I changed **one thing** (narrow broad questions + block ungrounded identifiers), reran 6× — the weak case went from failing to passing and fabrication disappeared.

Honest: one rule over-formalized a couple of answers, and the biggest remaining gap is **knowledge-base coverage** — a content fix, not a prompt fix.

Face validity — would a sales leader believe this?

The size is believable

The AI only compresses what it's genuinely good at — drafting plans, retrieving answers, scoring calls. The Manager's review time is **added back in**, so the headline cuts are net savings, not magic.

The direction is right

Every consequential decision still needs a human: the Manager approves plans and coaching notes, and the certification AI is **advisory** — the Manager makes the Pass/Fail call.

It’s grounded, not guessed

Tutor answers cite the source passage behind each claim (Faithfulness ~8.7/10 across runs). When the AI isn't sure, it **flags for review** instead of bluffing.

Where I’m honest

Certification is demoed on a synthetic 7-SDR cohort, and the recurring coaching saving assumes a typical weekly call volume — both clearly labeled as assumptions.

What I’d improve

Make the AI sharper

- Align knowledge-base docs to the test rubrics (the main remaining failure)
- Soften the rule that over-formalized two answers
- Capture real certification artifacts from the live cold-call sim

Make it production-ready

- Persist state to a real database (today: in-memory)
- Auth + role enforcement at the API layer
- Run the LLM eval suite in CI on every change

Thank you

SDR Onboarding Agent — an AI coworker with a human at every gate.

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Repo · `github.com/rsm-sanekar/sdr-onboarding-agent` **Demo** · `uv run python workflow_server.py` + `cd ui && npm run dev`

Questions?